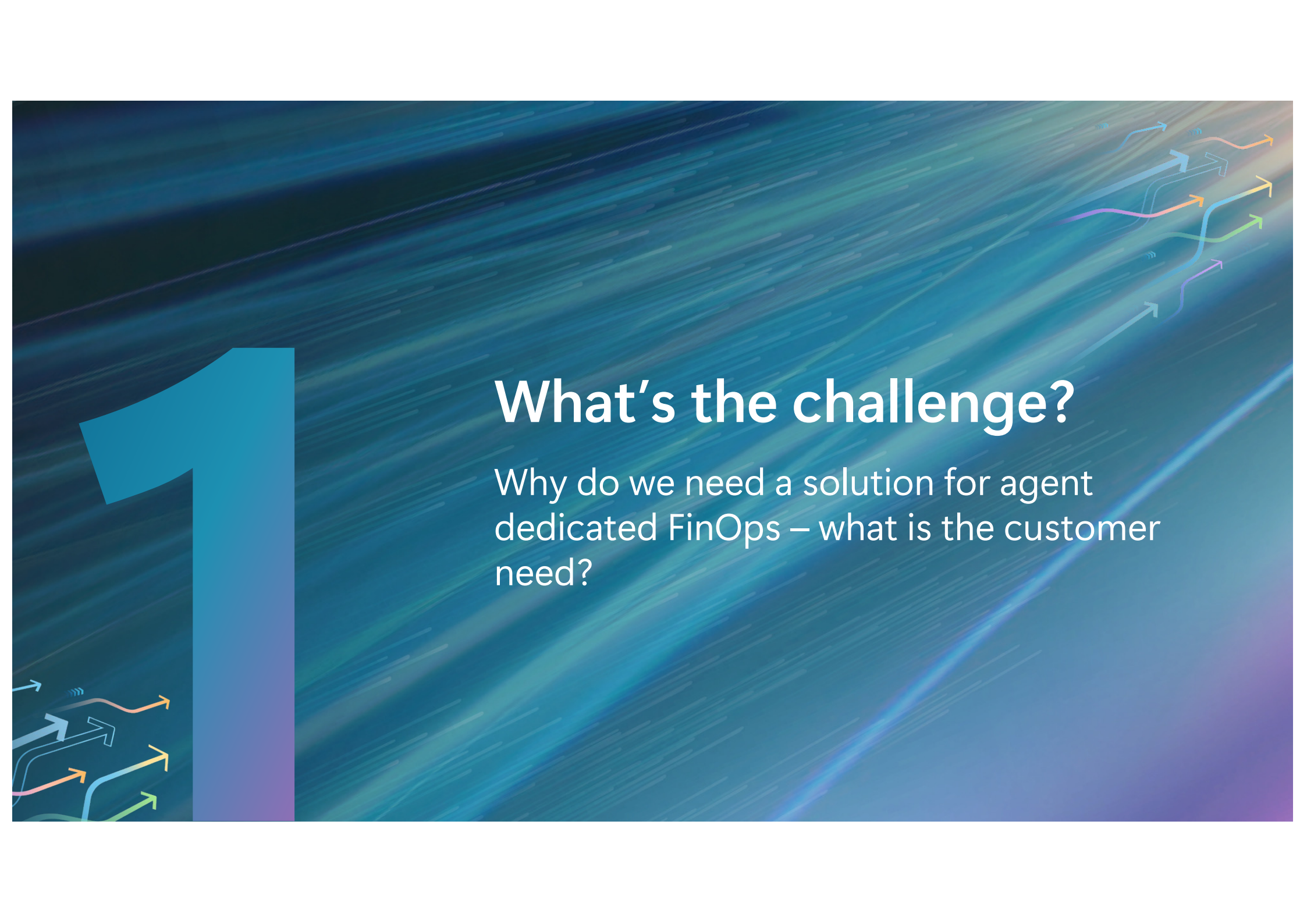




**Microsoft Frontier Company
Hackathon FY27**

FinOps for Agents

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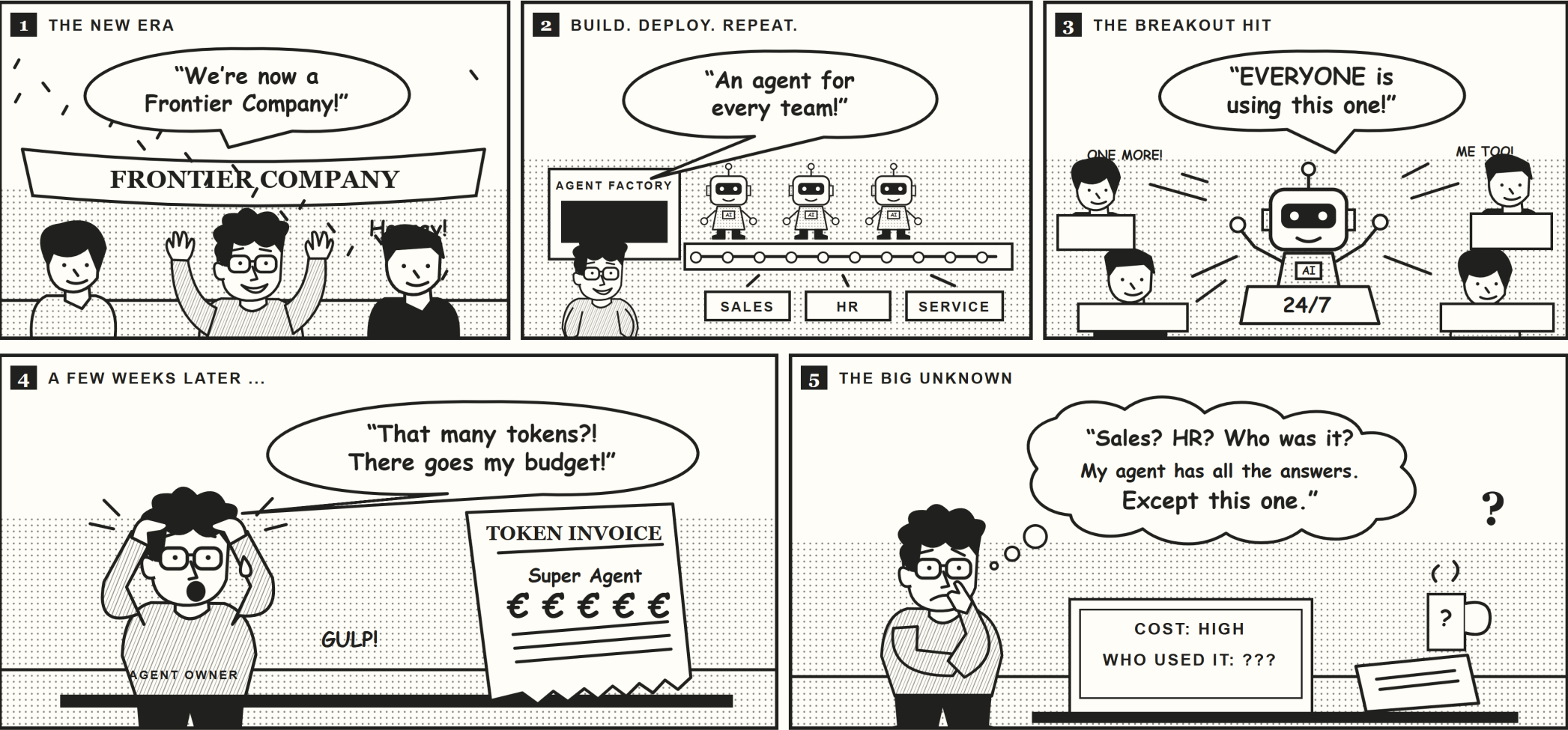


What's the challenge?

Why do we need a solution for agent dedicated FinOps – what is the customer need?

Big success. Bigger bill.

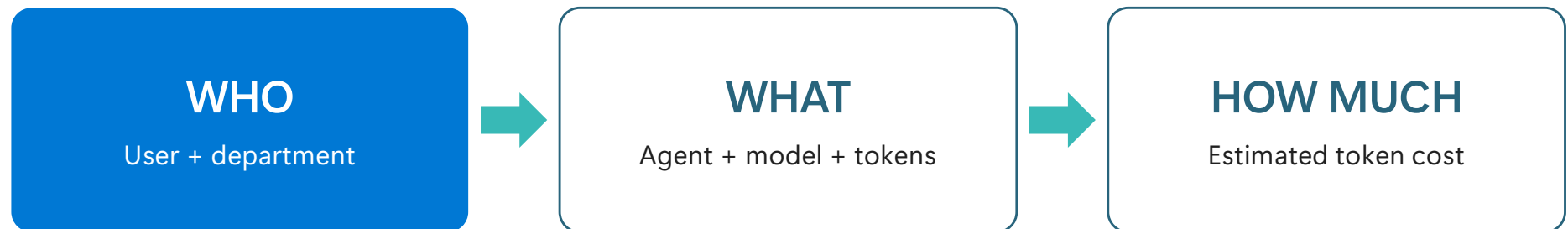
A STORY IN FIVE PANELS



Give every agent interaction a cost trail.

FinOps for Agents

Big customers, becoming Frontier Companies, bring hundreds of agents to life. With the help of ISD and CSU, they enable the whole company to deploy, publish and use those agents. But what happens, if the agent, provided by my department causes unpredicted costs due to heavy usage? Our customers are demanding a solution to track down the agent costs to users or departments for their internal billing.



A foundation for showback, chargeback, and better decisions.

Hackathon reference implementation · Estimates, not invoice reconciliation

Isn't there such a feature, yet?

FinOps for Agents



ISD Germany + Austria

Reach out to the architect's community in DE and AT, about such a solution – answers have been:

"I have not seen such a solution so far, but my customer will need that definitely!"

"My customer has already run into that issue – please let us know, if you have found a solution!"



AI Foundry Product Group

Reach out to the Foundry Product Group about adding such a FinOps feature to Foundry?

"It is not on the roadmap, yet."

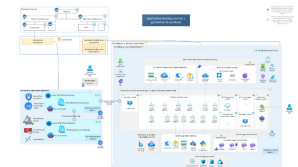


Azure AI Foundry

AI Landing Zone V-Team

Intense discussions about the use case itself and whether such a feature should be part of the product, the AI Landing Zone or left to the customer led to:

"Reach out to the PG and let us know, when you've built such thing. We definitely see the use case for that."





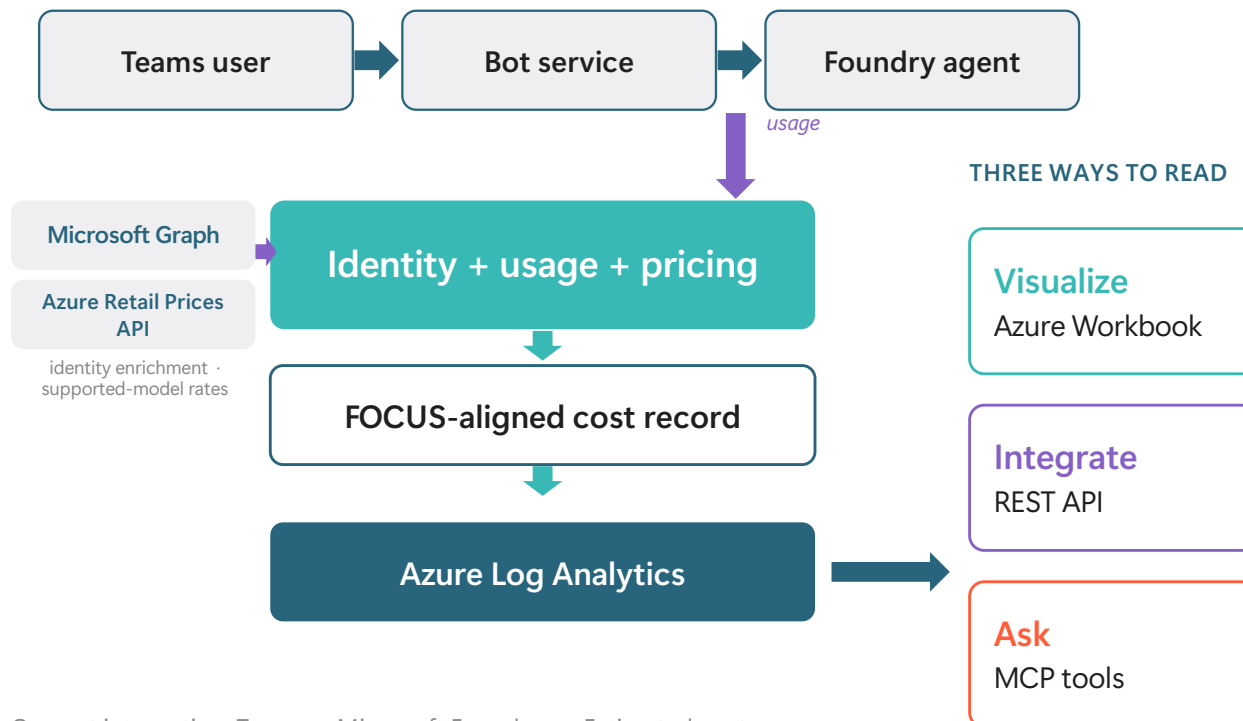
2

Our solution

What have we designed and built to tackle that? How are we going to make our Agent Owner happy again?

Capture once. Explain it three ways.

FinOps for Agents



Current integration: Teams + Microsoft Foundry · Estimated costs

We record the usage of an agent by tracking the bot service communication. We put the incoming information of the user query and the agent's answer into Log Analytics, including the meta data about token usage and model selection.

By connecting the Azure Retail Price API and Entra/Graph, the collected meta data can be mapped to real prices and users as well as their respective departments.

The architecture behind

FinOps for Agents

01 USE THE AGENT



Microsoft Teams

Employee asks a question and receives the answer



Azure Bot Service + Flask middleware

Routes messages to the agent
Captures identity and usage



Microsoft Foundry Agent Service

Agent + gpt-5-mini deployment
Returns answer and token usage

Same employee experience.

A separate measurement flow makes agent usage visible to the business.

02 ATTRIBUTE & MEASURE

Measured token usage.
Estimated token cost.
Department attribution depends on directory data quality.

API

Microsoft Graph Directory API

User identity and department
Enrichment where available



FinOps data layer Custom Python code

FOCUS-aligned record + validation
Tokens, agent, timing, cost estimate



Azure Log Analytics Cost telemetry store

FinOpsAgentMetrics_CL
Stores selected record fields

Identity + usage

HTTPS ingestion / HMAC signing

03 UNDERSTAND & ACT



Azure Workbooks + KQL queries

Department and agent usage
Trends and ad-hoc analysis

API

REST API Custom Flask endpoints

Department and billing views
JSON for scripts and integrations



Azure Functions MCP server

Cost-query tools for AI assistants
Ask FinOps questions naturally



Azure Monitor Alerts + Power BI reports

Configure thresholds and alerts
Connect Power BI for reporting

REST runs in the same Flask service.

Dashed = integrations to configure.

From a conversation to a cost breakdown.

OUR HACKATHON DELIVERABLES

“Which departments used this agent—and what did that usage cost?”

1 CAPTURE

Teams + Foundry integration
Model-reported token usage

2 ATTRIBUTE

Identity-enriched usage records
Supported-model cost estimates

3 EXPLORE

Workbook, REST API, MCP
Department and user views

Implemented in the repository · Live demo available on FDPO / Visual Studio subscription

**Demo setup is deployed and
presentation ready**

Can I get the check, please?

FinOps for Agents

```
● (.venv) → finops-for-agents git:(main) ✗ curl -s  
?department=HR" | jq  
{  
  "agent_name": "super-fun-coding-learn-agent",  
  "agent_total_cost": 1.609469,  
  "billed_cost": 0.23614,  
  "billing": [  
    {  
      "AvgCostPerRequest": 0.059035,  
      "Cost": 0.23614,  
    }  
  ]  
}
```

Log Analytics

Billing details are stored to Log Analytics for custom views and analysis or PowerBI dashboard connection.

REST-API

Customers want to consume such information via classic REST-API's – we've implemented that quite easy:

`customersAgentHub/finOpsAgent/agent/tennisCoach/billing?department=HR`

Agentic Access

Provide the information via an agent itself, that connects to the Log Analytics data foundation

"How much costs have the HR department created this months by using the TennisCoach agent?"



3 What's happening next?

How do we leverage that? Will that be shipped to all interested Agent Owners in the Foundry cosmos?

Learnings and Limitations

FinOps for Agents



Token Cost vs. Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)

- Using the Azure Retail Price API is a nice indication but may not reflect the real costs. Customers often have discounts or PTUs in place that may differ from the public prices.
- Focussing on token costs only is not enough. Agents usually rely on other services and data sources, causing another costs.
- Giving the agent owner rather a distribution of the agent usage might be helpful so that he/she can calculate that against the complete TCO.

The foundation is built. Trust is next.

FinOps for Agents

We connected agent usage to a cost-attribution workflow.

COMPLETE THE PICTURE

Resolve missing attribution

Reconcile estimated costs

MAKE IT RELIABLE

Secure access and resilient ingestion

Harden for production

EXTEND THE REACH

Add non-Teams channels

Explore agent-to-agent usage

DEPLOY

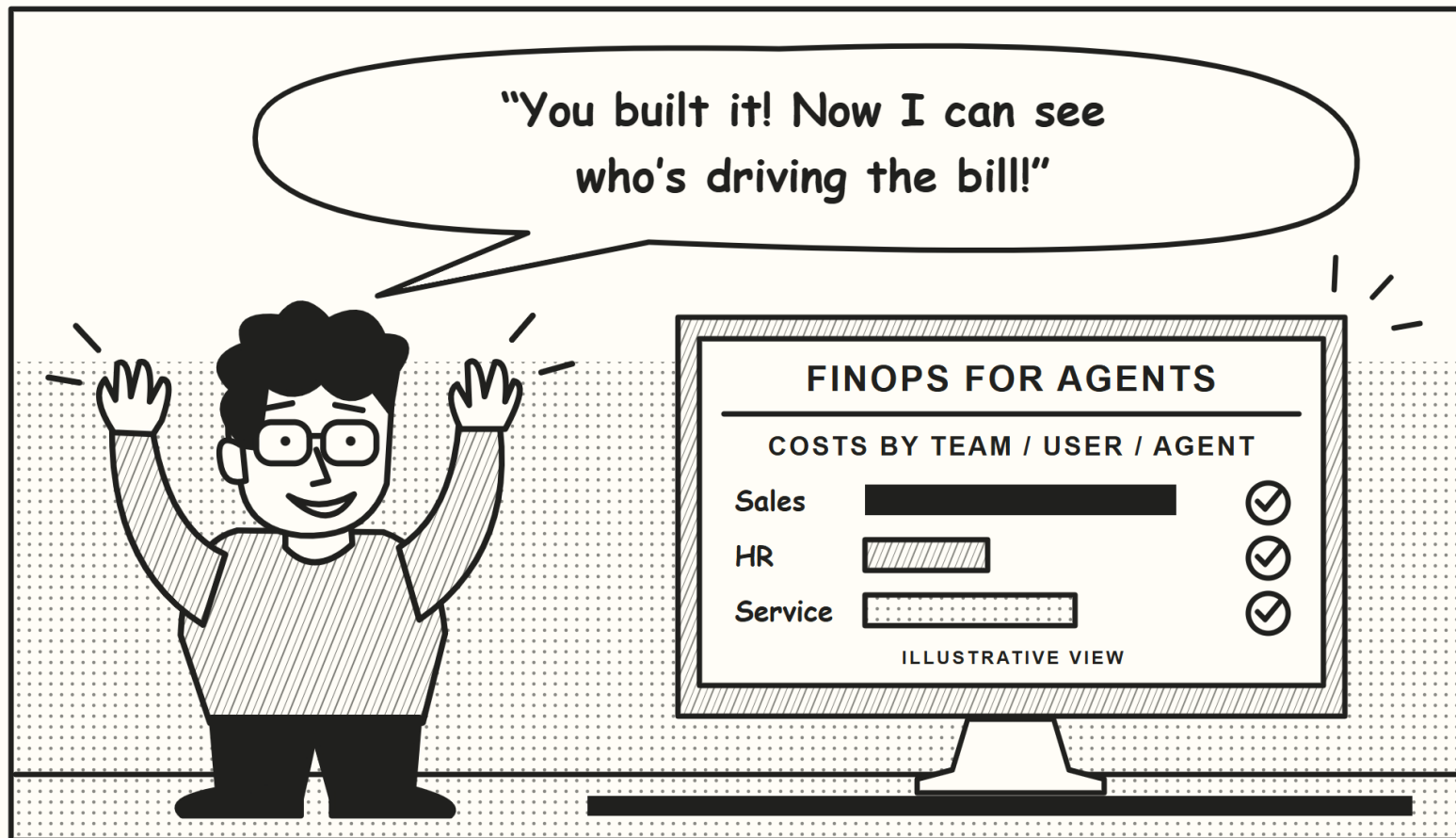
Bring the solution live to a real-world customer scenario.

First: **Commerzbank** (Germany)

SPREAD THE WORD

Present the solution to Product Group, ISD & CSU teams and the AI Landing Zone V-Team

Billing, without the guesswork.



Same agents. Clear costs. Happy owner.



THANK YOU